- Lab Introduction (AI understandable tone)

Introducing our lab, *Literacy, Language, and Content learning* in Education Sciences (LILACS)

- The Literacy, Language, and Content Learning in Education Sciences (LILACS) Lab investigates how K–12 students learn through engagement with various types of texts—across genres and modalities—and leverages these research findings to design and evaluate effective instructional strategies and educational technologies.
- Our current research particularly focuses on multilingual elementary students' language and reading comprehension as well as their science and social studies knowledge development.
- We collaborate closely with teachers and students in schools and are dedicated to bridging the gap between research and educational practice and policy.

- Here is the list of guiding principles for our work:
    - **We view reading comprehension as both processes and products.** We investigate not only the final outcome of what students comprehend, but also the active, cognitive strategies they employ while engaging with various texts.
    - **We believe reading is a fundamental vehicle for learning and growth.** For example, by interacting with text, students can learn about the natural and social worlds and build epistemological virtues (e.g., intellectual humility).
    - **We hold an asset-oriented view of multilingualism.** We view students' home languages and cultural backgrounds as powerful resources that enhance learning.
    - **We are committed to interdisciplinary research.** Housed in educational psychology and special education, we actively bridge insights from various disciplines such as cognitive psychology and learning sciences.

Lab director – HyeJin Hwang, Ph.D

- “I study how students learn from diverse texts
  because I believe reading is the fundamental means for learning.”

- I am an Assistant Professor at the Department of Educational Psychology (PsyF & SPED). I received my Ph.D at the University of Michigan. I was a former ESL/EFL teacher in Korea.
- Research interests:
    - the developmental processes of reading comprehension and content knowledge (science and social studies knowledge)
    - instructional approaches and educational technologies for supporting reading comprehension and content learning with focus on multilingual students in the elementary years.
- Current projects: See the project page
- Teaching
    - EPSY 5001 Learning, Cognition, Assessment (undergraduate course for preservice teachers)
    - EPSY 5216 Introduction to Research in Educational Psychology and Human Development (research methods course for graduate students)
    - EPSY 8116 Reading for Meaning: Cognitive Processes in the Comprehension of Texts (doctoral seminar course)
- Advising and mentoring
    - Personal statement about advising and mentoring: Advising and mentoring are critical components of my work. I view advising and mentoring as opportunities to grow together with advisees/mentees as scholars and human beings. I recognize my power and privilege that come from being an able-bodied, cis-gendered, Western-educated, English-speaking person, as well as from being a faculty member at a university.
    - To maximize your achievement and our collaborative learning, I have the following commitments to you as my student:
        - Cultivating a safe lab environment that values intellectual humility
        - Maintaining honest and respectful communication in a timely manner
        - Providing explicit guidelines and individualized scaffolding to support you in achieving your goals and program milestones
        - Unpacking hidden curricula in academia and research
    - To maximize your achievement and our collaborative learning, I expect following things from you as my student:
        - Aligned Research Interests: A commitment to research inquiry that aligns closely with the lab’s core focus areas
        - Intellectual humility – It helps us continuously learn from various perspectives and different types of feedback.
        - Honest and respectful communication in a timely manner

        - Proactive planning: Expect that we will start strategic goal setting and step-by-step planning early in your program and continue this practice at the beginning of each semester.
- Life outside work: I enjoy reading novels and watching movies. My favorite movie directors include Bong Junho, Jang Hangjun, and Yoon Ga-eun.